Eddie Esajian
559-904-7689 | info@teshag.com

BIOCHAR

Hold water. Build carbon. Support soil biology. | CDFA-registered organic input material

Forest-biomass wood biochar, screened to ¼-inch minus. A porous, stable carbon that stays in your soil and holds water and nutrients in the root zone. Applied on its own, biologically charged with liquid biology from our line, and/or blended with your compost or manure for a single pass. Delivered to Hanford, CA.

Water security under SGMA

Groundwater basins across the San Joaquin Valley, including those under Kings County, are classified as critically overdrafted under the Sustainable Groundwater Management Act, and local agencies must bring them to sustainability within 20 years of their plan submittal.[11] Every inch of water your soil holds in the root zone is water you do not have to pump twice. Biochar is a porous carbon that holds water, and the research is clearest in light, quick-draining soils:[1]

Plant-available water gain in published research

+45%	+21%	+14%
coarse (sandy) soils	medium soils	fine soils

What else it does for your soil

Stores carbon for the long haul

Biochar with an H:Corg ratio below 0.4 keeps roughly three-quarters of its carbon in soil beyond 100 years. This product measures 0.20.[2]

Holds nitrate in the root zone

In biochar-amended manure compost, up to 30% of nitrate was released only on later extractions (slow release). In a field wheat trial, biochar co-compost cut nutrient leaching versus biochar alone or compost alone.[3,4]

Habitat for soil life

Improving habitat for soil organisms is one of the stated purposes of the NRCS Soil Carbon Amendment standard for biochar and compost.[5]

Clean and low-salt

ECe of 0.22 means no added salt load. The pH of 8.13 and 5.7% liming value mean it will not acidify soil, and liming is a minor effect.

Screened for easy handling

Particles are ¼ inch and smaller, so it blends evenly with compost and manure and spreads uniformly.

Fits organic programs

Registered with CDFA as an organic input material; feedstock is forest biomass only.

Set realistic expectations. Biochar is a soil-building investment, not a yield booster in a bag. Across published studies the average crop response was about +10%, strongest in acidic or neutral and coarse- or medium-textured soils.[6] UC Davis researchers working with California soils note that large yield gains are not likely in fertile ground, and that water holding improved with walnut shell biochar in a sandy soil but not a fine-textured one.[7] We will tell you straight whether your ground is a good fit.

Make it work harder: custom blends

Biologically charged

Biochar's pores make it a studied carrier for microbial inoculants. We can biologically charge it on your farm, right before spreading, with liquid biology from our line of products, so the biology rides on the char. Field evidence is early and mixed: a finger millet trial did best with a fungal inoculant on biochar,[8] while in cowpea, biochar-carried rhizobia significantly increased nodule weight over uninoculated plants.[9] In a rice pot study, bacteria-charged biochar raised microbial load and nitrogen-cycling genes.[13] Treat it as a promising delivery method, not a guarantee.

Blended with your compost or manure

We blend biochar with your compost or manure on your farm, at the ratio your plan calls for, before spreading, so you spread once instead of twice. Pairing the two is also where the nitrate-holding research is strongest.[3,4] Compost-type biochar still lifted soil organic matter and moisture after 7 years in Tanzania.[14]

Getting it paid for: NRCS EQIP and CDFA Healthy Soils

NRCS EQIP. Soil Carbon Amendment (Conservation Practice Standard 336) is the federal practice that pays for biochar, alone or blended with compost or manure, as part of a conservation plan. Biochar must meet the standard's quality criteria, and our lab numbers are well inside them. NRCS assistance can cover applications up to 3 years in a row.[5, 12] States choose which practices they offer and set payment rates, so ask your local NRCS service center whether 336 is available in your county this fiscal year. NRCS takes applications year-round and ranks them at cutoff dates.

CDFA Healthy Soils Program. CDFA's 2026 practice guidelines (public-comment draft) add biochar as a new practice for cropland, orchards and vineyards, at 1 to 6 tons per acre over 1 to 3 years, with support of up to $250 per ton.[10]

Why 1 to 2 tons a year is plenty. At 1 to 2 tons per acre per application, three consecutive years of support builds up 3 to 6 tons per acre in your soil, inside the Healthy Soils range, without ever applying a heavy single dose.

We can help. Teshuva Ag offers technical assistance with the planning and paperwork, and supplies the biochar lab analysis and delivery records these programs ask for. Funding is competitive and not guaranteed, and payment may not cover the full cost.

Pricing

$52 per cubic yard

Delivered to Hanford, CA

Growers outside Hanford: call for pricing.

Rate per application	≈ Tons	Cost per application	If repeated 3 years
6 yd	≈ 1 ton	**$312/acre**	$936/acre
12 yd	≈ 2 tons	**$624/acre**	$1,872/acre

Tons are approximate, at 330 lb/yd³ as delivered. Material cost only. Blending and biological charging priced separately; call for a quote.

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Sources

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10. CDFA Healthy Soils Program 2026 Practice Guidelines (February 2026, draft for public comment), cdfa.ca.gov/oars/healthysoils.

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12. American Farmland Trust / USBI. Biochar Basics: Current Status of NRCS Incentive Payments (farmlandinfo.org, 2023).

13. Afzal M et al. (2025). Bacterial-charged biochar enhances plant growth and mitigates microplastic toxicity by altering microbial communities and soil metabolism. Plant Stress 17:100916 (rice pot study, microplastic-contaminated paddy soil).

14. Ernest B, Yanda PZ, Hansson A, Fridahl M (2024). Long-term effects of adding biochar on soil organic matter, soil organic carbon and soil moisture in Tanzania. Scientific Reports 14:30565.

Crop response varies with crop, soil, climate and management; no outcome is guaranteed. Funding program rules, availability and payment rates change and are set by NRCS and CDFA; this sheet is not a guarantee of eligibility or payment, so confirm with your local NRCS office or program administrator before purchasing. Pricing is subject to change and may vary by volume and delivery location. Always read and follow product labels.